



Now let's look at a tougher case.

*My Division.* My body is fatally injured, as are the brains of my two brothers. My brain is divided, and each half is successfully transplanted into the body of one of my brothers. Each of the resulting people believes that he is me, seems to remember living my life, has my character, and is in every other way psychologically continuous with me. And he has a body that is very like mine.

Let's call the resulting people *Lefty* and *Righty*. Then we seem to have four options:

- (1) You survive as A.
- (2) You survive as B.
- (3) You survive as both A and B.
- (4) You do not survive.

Parfit argues that none of (1)–(3) can be true. So, he thinks, we are stuck with  
option (4): you do not survive.

But this looks bad for the psychological theory; after all, you seem to have the right kinds of connections to both A and B.

That is why, he thinks, you can survive Hemisphere Transplant but not My  
Division.



Notice that a materialist could say much the same thing. They could say that what is required for your survival is a non-branching material relation to some future thing.

But here is an odd consequence of this view. Suppose that you wake up, and are told that you are the result of a hemisphere transplant operation. Next to you on another hospital bed is a body into whom the other hemisphere was transplanted.

You do not yet know whether that body will awake.

You think that you know that you are the person you remember being. But, if that other body survives to become a living person, you will not be the person you remember being.

Here's a quite different way of responding to My Division. Recall this option:

This also gives the psychological theorist the resources to resist the Teletransportation Argument. On this kind of view, premises (1) and (2) are false, because the psychological connections to Marsy and Venusy are branching connections.

You survive as  
Lefty and Righty.

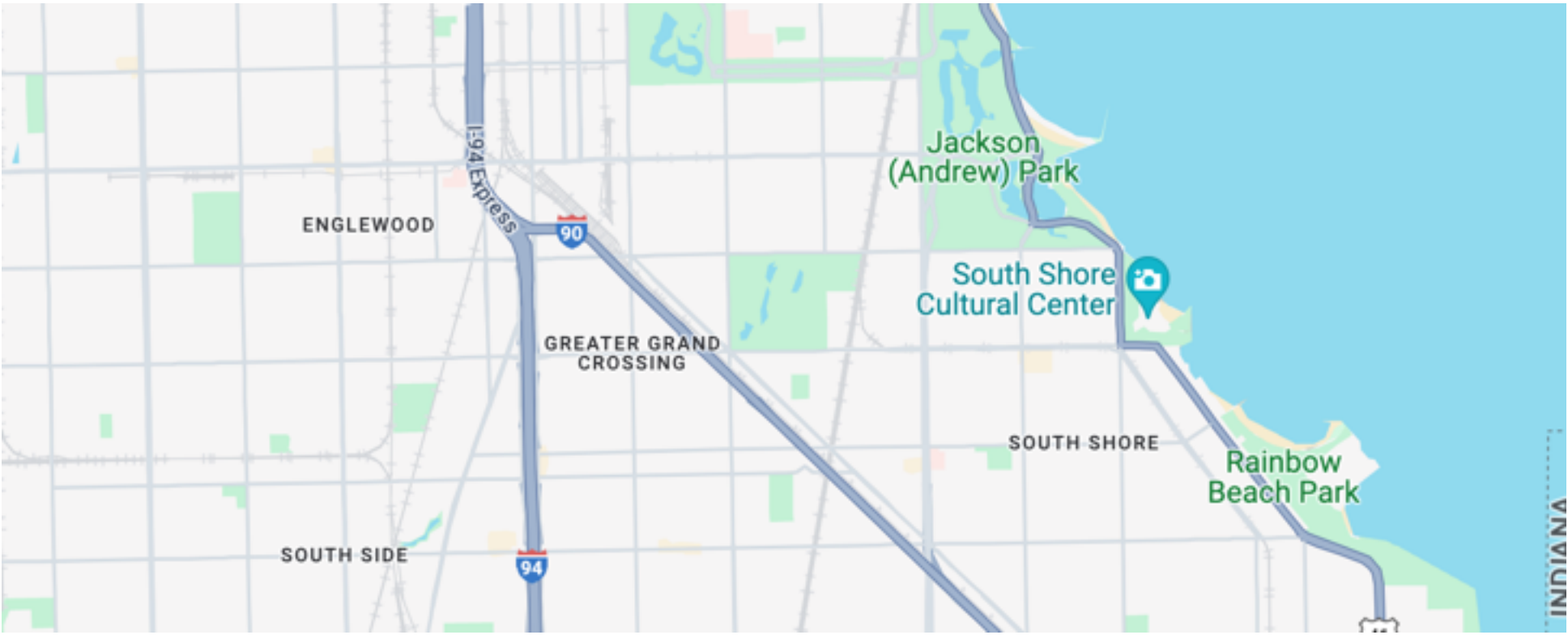
We rejected this on the grounds that Lefty is not identical to Righty, so that you cannot be identical to both. But this neglects a possibility: maybe you were already

*Lefty and Righty*. You thought that you were one person; but in fact you were already two.

This is a strange and surprising view. Here is one way to get your mind around it.

Consider a case in which two roads 'overlap' in space.





ENGLEWOOD

Jackson  
(Andrew) Park

South Shore  
Cultural Center

GREATER GRAND  
CROSSING

SOUTH SHORE

Rainbow  
Beach Park

SOUTH SIDE

INDIANA

One can describe this situation in a way which makes it seem mysterious. I-90 and I-94 are separate highways; the stretch of highway north of 65th street is one highway; and yet it is identical to both I-90 and I-94. How can this be???

The puzzle here is only superficial. Roads are things which have different spatial parts located in different places. Two roads can occupy the same space just by sharing some of the same parts. No big deal.

On one view, people -- and other objects -- have a relation to time which is similar to the relation in which roads stand to space. Like roads, we seem to have spatial parts. But on this view, we also have **temporal parts**. Just as I exist in separate locations by having separate spatial parts in those distinct locations, so I exist at different times by having different temporal parts in those different times.





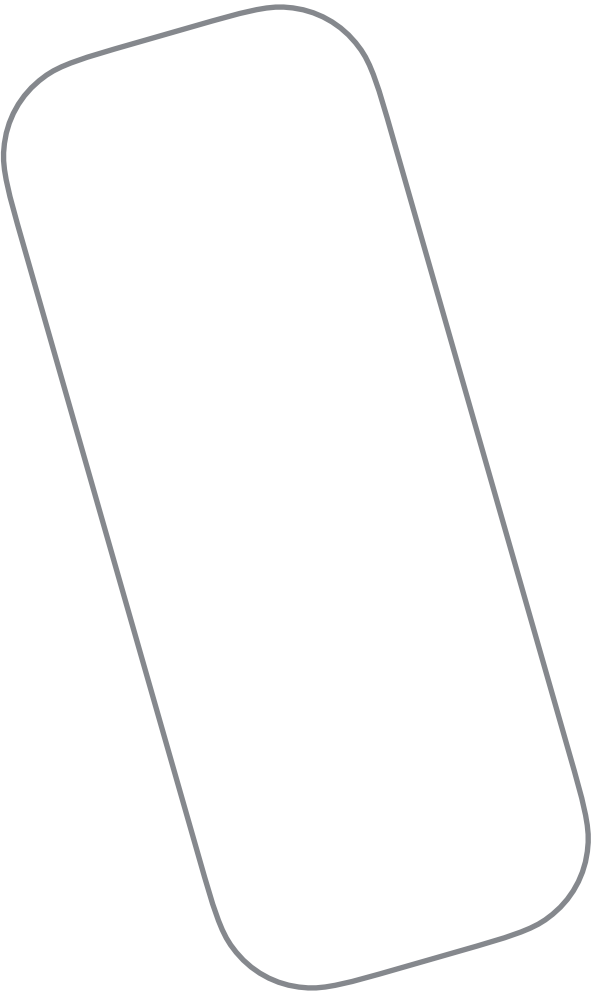


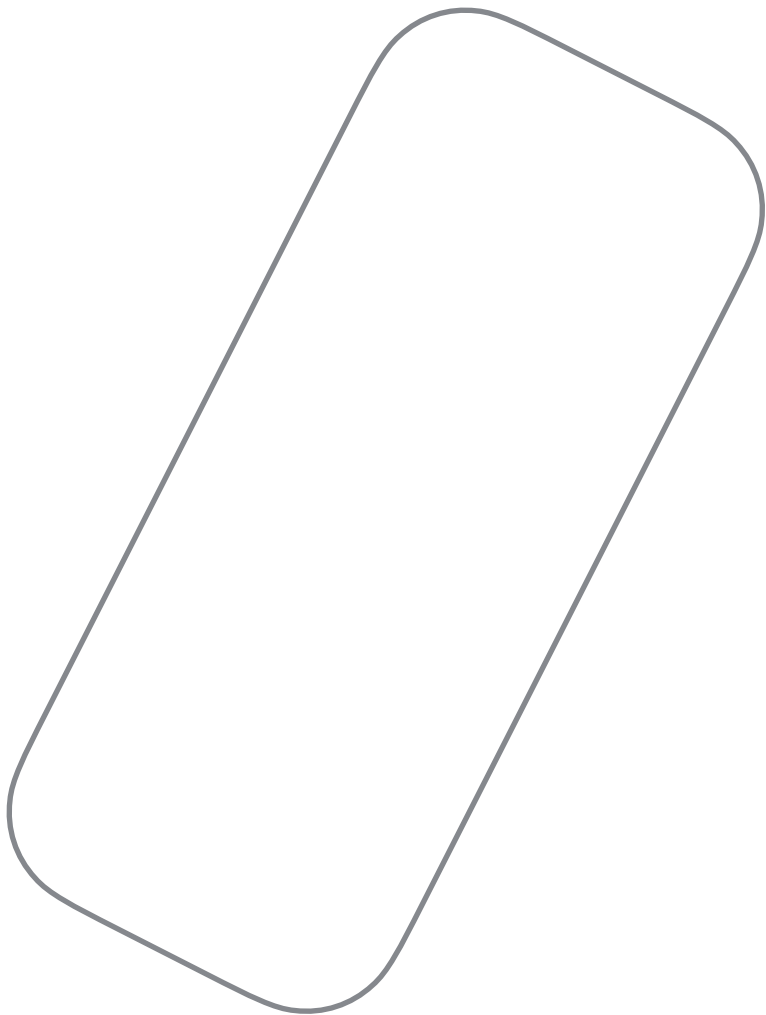
pre-division





post-division





On this view, Lefty and Righty  
are indeed distinct. But they  
have a temporal part in  
common: you, before the  
surgery.

This kind of view - on which survival is a matter of having different temporal parts at different times - is called **four dimensionalism.**

Four dimensionalism provides a way to be a materialist or psychological theorist without a non-branching clause. But it comes with a cost. You never know how many people are 'located' inside of one body. Indeed, you can't know, without knowing your future, how many people you are. This strikes some people as absurd.

This kind of view might also promise to help with the split brain cases. Perhaps individuals before the corpus callosum is severed are like the individual at the start of My Division.

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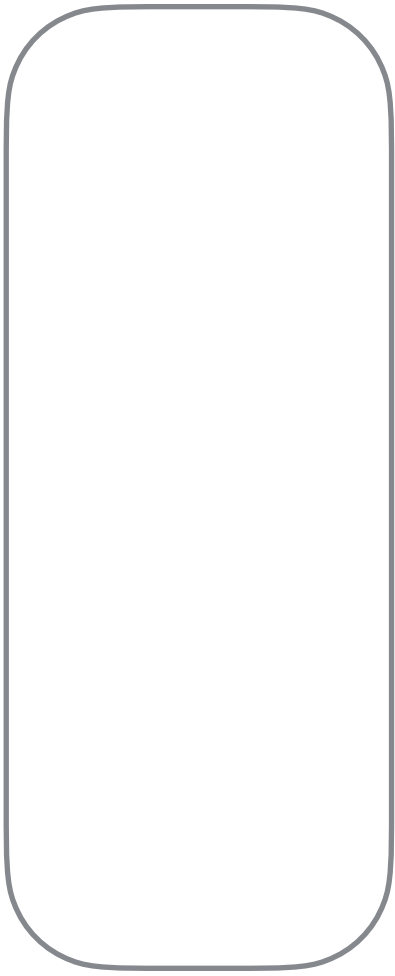
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There are also (as the contemporary philosopher Mark Johnston

prints out) practical problems.







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